CEU Economic Seminar Series: Long-Run Consequences of Propaganda in the Classroom

SEMINAR

Tuesday, Feb 20, 2024, 11:15 am – 12:30 pm
1100 Vienna, Quellenstrasse 51; QS B-505

CEU Department of Economics and Business

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Speaker
Jaakko Meriläinen

joint work with Matti Mitrunen

Abstract:

This study investigates the persistent economic impact of exposure to Marxist propaganda during childhood. Specifically, we explore the effects of a rogue educational experiment that exposed fifth graders in the Finnish municipality of Pirkkala to a history and social studies curriculum heavily influenced by Soviet and Marxist teachings between 1973-1975. Using comprehensive register data to track individuals over time and employing a generalized difference-in-difference approach, we demonstrate that those exposed to the propaganda as children had significantly lower incomes in adulthood compared to their non-exposed peers. We show that this effect partly stems from the exposed choosing ideologically more left-leaning occupations with lower wages. Additionally, we find substantial adverse effects of the propaganda on labor market participation, while finding no meaningful impact on further education. Our findings highlight the potential long-lasting consequences of early exposure to propaganda in classrooms on an individual's economic outcomes and later behavior.

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ONSITE EVENT

RSVP REQUIRED

REGISTRATION

VIENNA CAMPUS

Vienna Campus
Quellenstrasse 51
Room : QS B-505

HOST

Department of Economics and Business

AUDIENCE

Invited Guests

CEU Employees

CEU Students

CEU Alumni

CATEGORY

CEU Economic Seminar Series

CONTACT

lafferthonj@ceu.edu

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Postal Address Austria: Central European University Private University | Quellenstraße 51 | A-1100 Wien, Austria | Vienna Commercial Court | FN 502313 x
Postal Address Hungary: Közép-európai Egyetem | Nádor u. 9. | 1051 Budapest, Hungary

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